Study Guide

In the style of Edexcel and OCR

How far do you agree that it was the creation of the state of Israel that fuelled the growth of Arab nationalism during the years 1948–73?

Exam tips

The cross-references are intended to take you straight to the material that will help you to answer the question.

First, read Chapter 4 again.

In this essay, you have to assess the degree to which the creation of Israel was a factor in developing and sustaining Arab nationalism. To answer the question of 'How far?' and thus achieve a high grade, you need to examine the importance of the state of Israel in the context of other influencing factors.

First, you might explain briefly what you mean by 'Arab nationalism' (page 65). Then, in examining the importance of the existence of Israel, you should consider:

- how the UN decision to create the new state united the Arab world and contributed to the invasion by Arab armies in May 1948 (pages 20–2)
- how the defeat of Arab armies increased hatred of Israel and, for the next 25 years, the one thing that united the Arab world was its refusal to recognise the new state
- the formation of the PLO, in order to liberate Palestine and destroy Israel, helped to sustain Arab nationalism
- the importance of the 1967 and 1973 wars in strengthening anti-Israeli and pro-Arab nationalist feelings (pages 52–7).

You will also need to examine the role of Egypt, especially President Nasser, in fuelling Arab nationalism. In particular, you should explain his defiance of the West, as shown in:

- Nasser's use of the radio in building opposition, throughout the Arab world, to the Baghdad Pact (page 67)
- Egypt's 'victory' over the West (specifically Britain and France) in the Suez War, 1956 (pages 68–9)
- the formation of the UAR, again strengthening feelings of Arab nationalism (page 70).

The best answers will show the links between Israel's existence and other factors fuelling Arab nationalism. For example, much Arab nationalism was essentially anti-Western, especially in its opposition to what was seen as the West's creation of, and continuing support for, the state of Israel. The Suez crisis of 1956 shows this most clearly: it was portrayed, throughout the Arab world, as aggression by Western 'imperialists' and their 'illegitimate offspring', Israel.

Be sure to provide a clear and strong conclusion that answers the question. Do not sit on the fence.